



BGMI bans 70k+ accounts

BGMI bans 71,000 accounts as a part of countermeasures Krafton is taking against cheaters. <https://digit.in/jan22-67>



Steam starts 2022 with a bang

Steam records highest number of concurrent users with 28 million users on January 2nd, 2022. <https://digit.in/jan22-68>

THE RISE OF VFX IN HOLLYWOOD

While there were advances being made in the world of VFX each coming day, news films in the US were recreating real life events for their growing audiences using models. This saw the rise of classic practical effects such as explosions created using gunpowder, cardboard buildings being burnt, wooden models being pulled along by strings, water pistols being used to recreate the jets from a fire hose and so on. Given, they weren't very good as a generation



of new craftsmen and technicians worked with the new technology but then again, the audience were just as undemanding at the time.

By the 1910s however, everything had started getting a lot more sophisticated. The first VFX specialists started to appear (though they wouldn't start getting credits until the mid 1920s) and pioneered the use of techniques such as using glass mattes for scene extensions. Industry giants like DW Griffith also started developing the visual language of film using techniques such as shot transitions, iris-in and iris-out for dramatic effect, and so on.

In the 1920s however is when we saw Hollywood really starting to use model effects especially in historical epics such as Ben Hur and the Thief

of Baghdad, while Cecil B deMille led his army of Israelites through sliced walls of double exposed jelly to simulate the parting waters of the Red Sea in The 10 Commandments.

THE FUTURE

Through all of this though, the 20's really belonged to the Germans who were way ahead of their American counterparts in technique and execution, and in particular Fritz Lang's astonishing Metropolis (1926).

The film is still astonishing after almost an entire century. Lang literally threw all the top technologies of his time into the movie and made sure everything was utilised to its fullest potential and used matte painting, rear projection, compositing techniques, and pushing the art of miniatures further than ever before to make the animated cityscapes of the film's most impressive opening sequence.

Now came the 1930s, best categorised under the era of cautious progress since it saw the steady development of many dominant techniques such as rear projection, travelling mattes, and miniatures. The technique that was most developed though was rear projection as it steadily grew more and more popular due to the demands of a primitive new technology, 'Talkies' (yes, that old



cinema near your house with talkies in its name once used to be the most advanced theatre in your city) making location filming nigh on impossible. As a result, by the end of the decade, rear projection

FACTOID

Metropolis was also the first film to successfully use the Shufan Process, an in-camera optical technique invented by Eugene Shufan which used a combination of angled mirrors, paintings, and live action to create the impression of live actors occupying huge sets, and is essentially seen as a primitive precursor of blue screen.

screens as large as 14.5 m were in use, with the key to success being matching both the lighting and the focal lengths of the background and studio camera exactly.

The introduction of optical printers at the time also helped a lot in bettering the image quality especially when combining the disparate elements for travelling matte work. If you wanna think about a few touchstones from the decade, King Kong would probably be the best example along with many of the horror movies made by Universal Studios during the time.

By the time we get to Orson Welles' classic Citizen Kane (1941), you have a